Week in the Life of a $50M CEO in Lake Como

Channel: Tim Luong · Published: Nov 10, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5i8rQHnJvMA Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Tim Luong vlogs a week in Lake Como for a college friend's wedding — covering a $50K crypto re-entry, a food-poisoning nightmare, candid reflections on entrepreneurship vs. traditional careers, evolving wealth goals, and the nostalgia of reconnecting with fraternity brothers after 10 years.

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🏨 Arrival at Lake Como & Hotel Vibes 0:05

- Tim and a friend check into the **CR Hotel Tremezzo** on Lake Como
  - Plans for the day: relax, read a book, explore Lake Como, and attend a wedding as the main event
  - Frames the vlog as a behind-the-scenes look at a Lake Como wedding
- Hotel staff immediately brings a romantic shared bottle of wine
  - Tim and friend joke about being given "romantic" treatment as two guys
- Reflects on lifestyle inflation trap:
  - A drink costs €100 — "That's how they get you. You upgrade your lifestyle too fast... you're right back to square one."

💰 Crypto Re-Entry: $50K Bet on Solana & Pump.fun 0:50

- Decided to re-enter crypto after charts looked bullish the prior week
- **Total investment: $50,000**
  - **$25,000 into Solana**
  - **$25,000 into Pump.fun**

- Rationale for Pump.fun:
  - Retail/memecoin traders are very active on the platform
  - "Pump.fun is like printing money" — sees it as a fundamentally strong business model
  - Charts also confirmed the thesis technically
- Bullish on broader crypto market reviving after "dead dead dead for like the last 2 years"
- Adds standard disclaimer: "This is not financial advice" — repeated twice
- Upside contingent on crypto markets continuing to run

🍕 Food, Fitness Philosophy & Daily Routine 1:20

- Orders chocolate chip pancakes, an iced latte, and a 2,000-calorie pizza during the trip
- Personal fitness philosophy:
  - "The difference between me and other people who work out is I work out so I can eat."
  - Loves food; exercises specifically to avoid getting fat from eating — not for aesthetics or performance
- Morning routine anchor: espresso or iced latte → "I sit down in the mornings. I have an espresso or iced latte and I'm happy."
- Day structure in Lake Como (the unglamorous reality):
  - Work during the day
  - Optional: spa/sauna
  - Dinner at 8:30 p.m. with the wedding group
- Honest about content vs. reality gap:
  - "90% of the time I'm not posting working. I post 10% of my life that is not working."
  - People assume he doesn't work because he only posts the highlight reel
  - Goal of this vlog: show the boring, working side alongside the exciting moments

🎓 Wedding Pre-Party: Reconnecting with College Friends 4:20

- **Food poisoning derailed 24 hours** before the pre-party
  - Mid-dinner at Michael's wedding dinner, Tim felt suddenly nauseous
  - Had to leave abruptly; began gagging/vomiting within 30 seconds of walking to the Uber
  - Spent an entire day bedridden
- Pre-party vibe: orange and white theme at a Lake Como venue
- Reunites with the groom (Michael) and old fraternity brothers from UCLA — some not seen in **10 years**
  - Mutual friend nicknamed "Kitty the Fridge" — described as 5'5" but built extremely stockily
- Still recovering, nervous about drinking: "Imagine I yak all over this beautiful wedding."
- Marriage/relationship reflection at the pre-party:
  - Attending back-to-back weddings is making him genuinely want to get married
  - Admits he'd need to "spend a year focused on finding a wife" but also recognizes forcing it won't work

- Friends push back: in your 20s you're not open to it; mid-30s is when it naturally clicks after "getting the party out of your system"
- Tim: "My time is coming."

- Senior year at UCLA context:
  - First half of college Tim didn't go out much
  - Senior year epiphany: "If I don't party in college, I'm going to regret it" → went out **four nights a week** the entire senior year
- Spotlights friend Russ: partied until 3–4 a.m., still in the gym by 7 a.m. with bloodshot eyes

🧠 Reflections on Career, Entrepreneurship & UCLA 6:21

- Tim's 20s framework: "Most of my 20s was focused on making money — how do I make money."
  - After hitting that milestone: pivoted to "what's next?"
  - Discovered genuine passion for making content about business
  - "I can see myself doing this for the next 10–20 years" — and it also makes money
- Career evolution insight:
  - Early 20s: pursue whatever makes money first, even if not passionate about it
  - Later: pursue what you're passionate about AND that makes money
- YouTube as a declared goal — the reaction:
  - Friends asked his #1 wish; he said "I want to have a big audience on YouTube and be able to have a career there"
  - Response from peers: **complete silence / confusion** — "What do you mean YouTube?"
  - Realization: his ability to pivot freely into new careers/hobbies is **an uncommon mindset**, not a default one
- College brainwashing critique (conversation with friend Joey):
  - College pushes you onto a traditional career path before you've had time to figure out what you want
  - "You don't know what you want to do in life when you're 18, 19, 20."
  - Seeing successful peers go to Wall Street, consulting, or med school makes you assume that's the only path
  - After getting the first job, people stay 10 years because pivoting feels impossible (more bills, more expenses)
  - "They think you can't" — but the constraint is psychological, not real
- **UCLA entrepreneurship stats** (conversation with Joey at the wedding):
  - UCLA class size: ~6,000 people
  - 10 years later, they can only identify **fewer than 10 people** who started a company
  - Even doubling to account for unknowns: ~10 out of 6,000 = roughly **0.16%**
  - "College isn't made for entrepreneurs" — UCLA excelled at producing Wall Street, consulting, and medical professionals

    - Comparison: Stanford and Harvard have notably higher entrepreneurship rates
    - Tim was **rejected twice** from the UCLA startup accelerator program despite feeling qualified
- Wealth goals evolution — 20s vs. 30s:
    - 20s goal: "How do I make $100 million at any expense possible?"
    - Entering 30s reframe: **"How do I get to $100 million WITHOUT sacrificing health, friendships, family, or life experiences along the way?"**

> The better framework isn't